

Document Title: HGV Eco Driving Training Standard

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Document Control

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Standard Requirements which will be subject to Audit

This Standard contains the essential elements required to meet the approval threshold for the Department of Transport HGV Eco Driving Standard.¹ It also contains best practice examples and suggestions which may aid training providers in delivering successful training interventions. The core standards which will be assessed as part of initial approval and ongoing auditing are shared in the document with the notation ‘*’ and listed within the appendix called Auditable Standards. Where a heading is marked as part of the core standard, the examples contained within the subheadings will form part of the assessment criteria, but they are not necessarily all required to meet the standard unless marked with an ‘*’ individually.

¹ It should be noted that the Department of Transport HGV Eco Driving Standard is a voluntary standard, awarded to those training providers who decide to apply and who meet the requirements set out in this document.

1. Scope

This standard specifies requirements for HGV Eco driving coaching programmes aimed at improving driving efficiency and reducing environmental impact through reducing fuel consumption, energy management & maintenance efficiencies. It covers aspects of coaching delivery, safety protocols, performance measurement, follow-up support, driver training and coaching, assessment and approval.

2. Terms and Definitions

- **Assessing Body:** an organisation appointed by the Department of Transport to devise oversee and update as needed standards applicable to Eco Driving Training in Ireland and to approve Eco Driving Training Providers, Trainers and Master Trainers. The assessing body will also maintain a panel of Subject Matter Experts (SME's) approved by the Department of Transport for the management and oversight of the standard.
- **Approved HGV Eco Driving Training Provider:** an organisation or person approved by the assessing body to offer and conduct eco driving training programmes to the public in line with these standards. Where the person is not an Approved HGV Eco Driving Master Trainer this person may not deliver in cab coaching or train an in-house coach.
- **Approved HGV Eco Driving Master Trainer:** a person who is a recognised ADI or has a minimum of 3 years licensed experience in the category of vehicle. They are a trainer approved by the assessing body in relation to these standards to deliver train the trainer training for in house coaches and to the public via an approved eco driving training provider.
- **Approved Driving Instructor (ADI):** A person who is currently registered with the RSA as an ADI for the relevant vehicle category and approved to teach learner drivers.
- **Coaching:** A developmental process whereby an in-house coach supports an appropriately licensed colleague in achieving a specific personal or professional goal by providing training and guidance.
- **Eco-Will:** Widespread Implementation for Learner Drivers and Licensed Drivers short duration eco-driving training programs for licensed drivers in 13 European countries. Information available at <https://www.cieca.eu/project/33>.
- **In-House Coach:** A non-ADI individual trained in line with these standards by an Approved HGV Eco Driving Master Trainer to deliver the HGV Eco driving coaching programme for professional drivers within their own organisation. In house coaches will also have completed a recognised train the trainer course.
- **Trip Computer:** A vehicle's built-in device that provides data on fuel consumption, distance travelled, and other performance metrics.

- **TREATISE:** EC project operating from January 2005 to June 2007 that provides free training on sustainable transport subjects, primarily for energy and transport professionals. [TREATISE Cleaner Fuels & Vehicles](#)
- **SAFED: Safe and Fuel-Efficient Driving (SAFED)** is a theory and practical driver training programme that aims to re-educate drivers in safer driving, modern fuel-efficient driving techniques and to reduce a driver's risk of being involved in a collision. [SAFED Final Report \(europa.eu\)](#)
- **Subject-Matter Expert (SME)** is someone who has extensive knowledge in Driver training and Eco-driving. This expertise is typically demonstrated through their degree, licensure, and years of professional experience, SMEs are proposed by the Assessing Body and approved by the Department of Transport.

3. Assumptions

3.1. Driver Competency

- The standards outlined here assume that all participants are already experienced competent & licensed HGV drivers. No basic driving instruction will be included within the eco driving standards.
- Where HGV Eco-Driving training is being delivered concurrently with new Driver Training, all in-cab instruction must be in compliance with established guidance of the Road Safety Authority (RSA). Only an ADI is allowed in the cab with a driver that does not hold a full license for the vehicle.

4. Safety Protocols

4.1. Where relevant, an ADI instructor must communicate to the driver that their presence in the cab is the role of HGV Eco-Driving trainer and the driver should not assume any advice offered is an instruction. The driver remains fully responsible for the vehicle and compliance with the rules of the road regardless of any advice offered by the trainer or coach.

*5. Coaching Delivery

5.1. HGV Eco-Driving Training Requirements

*Classroom based instruction should be led by an Approved HGV Eco Driving Master Trainer OR an Approved HGV Eco Driving Training Provider OR In-House Coach. The instructor must have appropriate knowledge/expertise specific to the content they are delivering, including, but not limited to:

- **Eco Will**
- **TREATISE**
- **SAFED**

Or

the assessing body will consider other qualifications that meet a similar standard on an individual basis.